Leon Sandler

Independent Researcher

Northbrook, Illinois, USA

sandler.leon@gmail.com

ORCID 0009-0007-4584-808X

8 November 2026

The Editor-in-Chief

Computer Methods and Programs in Biomedicine

Elsevier

Dear Editor,

I submit the manuscript “MyUncleVision: An Interpretable Lattice-Based Framework for Unsupervised Anomaly Discovery in Whole-Slide Histopathology Images” for consideration as a research article in Computer Methods and Programs in Biomedicine.

Unsupervised discovery in whole-slide images needs to keep artifacts and routine histology out of its findings and to hand experts places to look at. The manuscript presents MyUncleVision, an open pipeline that places patch embeddings on a tissue lattice, judges appearance rarity at several prevalence scales, smooths the score over the lattice, and ranks, maps and explains regions across slides. Its order and entropy quantities generalize those of the maintenance-lattice framework MyUncle from two to d dimensions and equal them exactly at d = 2 (tested against the unmodified core). It runs from one command in a Docker container, which I built and ran end to end.

The study is explicit about what it shows and does not show. It is evaluated only on synthetic slides with planted anomalies and artifacts, written by me: a development cohort used to choose the settings, and a held-out cohort of 16 slides with three unseen anomaly types, about 1% prevalence and stain shifts, evaluated once with frozen settings. The results are mixed and reported as such. Lattice smoothing raised the spatial coherence of every scorer; the frozen score was the best of all methods on the held-out cohort with DINOv2 (average precision 0.59) but poor with handcrafted features (0.04); a Mahalanobis baseline smoothed in the same way scored higher on the development cohort; and the disorder and contact axes of the lattice helped with handcrafted features and hurt with DINOv2, so they are optional diagnostics. The platform has not been applied to real tissue, and no pathologist has reviewed any output. The manuscript specifies the evaluation protocol for kidney slides (Kidney Precision Medicine Project) without reporting it. I understand that the journal may prefer that

evaluation to be part of the paper, and I would welcome the editor's view on whether to submit it later or now as a software and methods paper.

The software was developed for the NIDDK/HeroX Kidney AI Discovery Challenge; no entry has been submitted at the time of writing, and challenge participation would not constitute independent validation. The code, tests, benchmarks and results are open at https://github.com/sandlerleon/MyUncleVision and archived at https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.24066260 (software) and https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.24066256 (manuscript preprint).

A generative AI tool (Claude, Anthropic) assisted with writing and testing the code, running the analyses and drafting the text and figures; I reviewed and edited all of it and take full responsibility, as disclosed in the manuscript. The manuscript is original and is not under consideration at any other journal. I am the sole author. I have no competing interests to declare and the work received no funding.

Thank you for considering this submission.

Sincerely,

Leon Sandler